

necting the card to the LCD internally itself, but will still have the power cable sticking out.

Once this was done, we connected everything up—power, SATA, IDE, etc., and prayed that we wouldn't hear anything blow. We didn't, thankfully. There we had it, a case mod that literally cost us nothing but beads of sweat and a drop of blood or two (no tears; we're men here). It's easily achievable, and you can start building one tomorrow.

To The Extreme

A day after we were done, some of the designers dropped by to look at our proud feat. Now designers are a hard bunch to please, and the looks they were giving our mod said it all. "Give it to us for a few days..." said Pradip. "...With permission to do as we please," continued Vijay.

Now obviously, the designers were willing to spend a little money to beautify the mod, so there went our whole "almost free" concept. They did promise to keep it as cheap as possible though.

For those of you at home who fancy yourself as artists, you can do something along the lines of what our designers cooked up. This is where things go into extreme case modding territory, and though not necessary, it does add that extra something that you can show off to your friends.

The design guys decided to use clay and Plaster of Paris (PoP) to build a monster PC—literally. After drawing up some sketches—a very important step if you want to do something like this—they began their work. Amrut, one of our photographers, volunteered to lend us a hand (literally) and we used his hands to make the casts for the hands that you will see in the finished product. He also has some experience working with sun-board—used to build props—so he offered to pretty up the bezel.

First the guys put Amrut's hands in a clay cast, in the desired position. Once it was hardened, they removed it and then used that cast to create another hand made of PoP. The trick is to oil the surface of the clay cast and then add the PoP. Once it's all hardened, you have to carefully break away the clay to get at the completed hand.

For the head of our monster, they decided to camouflage that "ugly looking DVD drive" and also include the webcam that we had as its eye. Now there is no cast being used here, just the skill of a designer like Pradip. If you're doing this at home, make sure you can draw straight, or get one of your artist friends to help you out. After doing the necessary sketches, Pradip began sculpting the head. He used PoP to make the head and made the lower jaw separately, and then fixed it together.

The CRT case we had used was also painted to give it a mouldy, moss-covered look. The guys used spray paint for this.

Once everything was done, the hands and head were also painted. They were then attached in place using screws and more PoP.

In just four days (with five people working on it), we had our very own monster PC. At least for this month, we took care of our collective boredom. To be honest, I can't wait to see what our boredom drives us to do next month. Overall a very interesting five days, and the best bit is that because my office computer was used for the mod, I get to keep this monster PC as my own! ■

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16



That's our monster's head. We told him what his taxes for this year were and his jaw dropped!

17



Painting the hands using spray paint. They don't look scary yet, but wait awhile

18



Giving the case a mouldy old look. Remember kids, clean your PCs and no monsters will come out of them

19



Err. Giving the monster's hand a helping hand?

20



Can you say, "Grrr"?